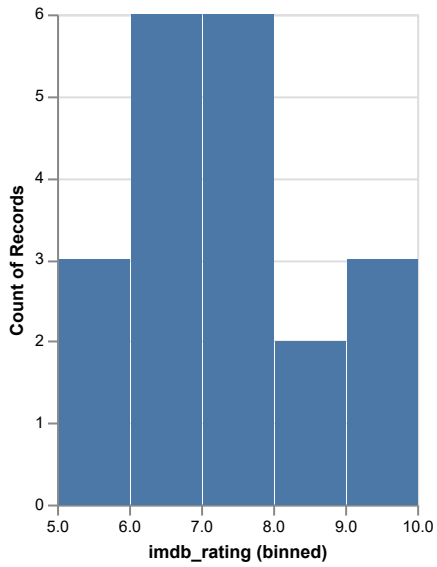
# Movie Ratings and Box-Office Performance

## Executive summary

This 20-film dataset shows a broadly mid-to-high-rated portfolio, with meaningful differences in critical reception and commercial performance by genre. **Thriller** is the strongest genre for critical consistency and total revenue, while **Comedy** produces the highest average box office per film in this small sample. Only **5 of 20 films (25%)** meet the defined hit threshold of an IMDb rating of at least 8.0.

## Overall rating trends

IMDb ratings range from **5.2 to 9.5**, with an average of **7.21** and a median of **7.15**. Twelve films (60%) are rated from 6.0 to 8.0, so most titles cluster around solid—but not exceptional—critical reception.



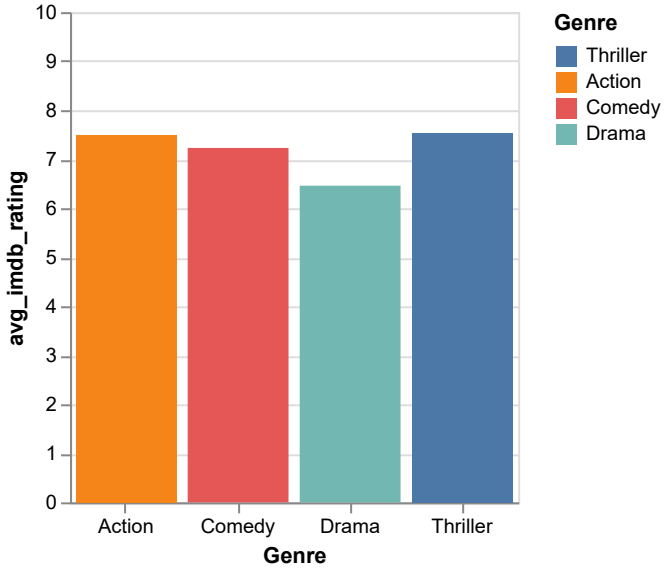

The distribution supports a portfolio strategy focused on lifting the broad middle of the slate: relatively few films reach the 8.0 hit threshold, while a small tail performs below 6.0.

## Highest-rated genres

| Genre | Films | Average IMDb rating | Hit films | Hit rate |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Thriller | 7 | 7.53 | 3 | 42.9% |
| Action | 5 | 7.50 | 1 | 20.0% |
| Comedy | 3 | 7.23 | 1 | 33.3% |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Drama | 5 | 6.46 | 0 | 0.0% |

**Thriller** narrowly leads Action on average rating and accounts for **3 of the 5 hits**. Drama has the weakest average rating and no films rated 8.0 or higher.

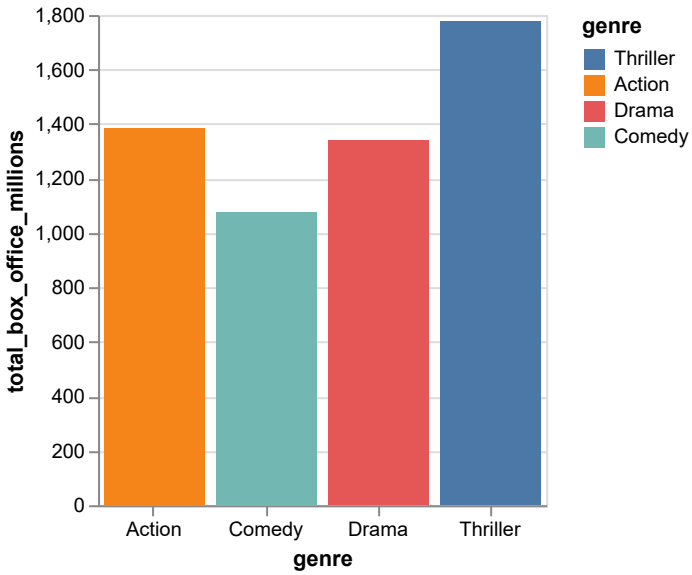


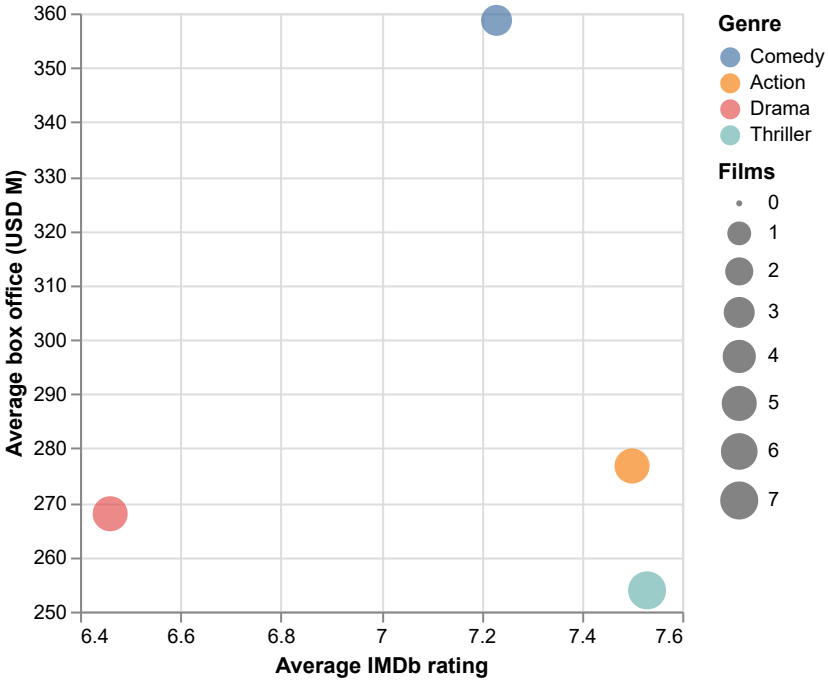

# Revenue performance by genre

The full sample generated **$5.577 billion** in box office revenue (values are recorded in millions).

| Genre | Total box office ($M) | Average box office per film ($M) |
|---|---|---|
| Thriller | 1,777.2 | 253.9 |
| Action | 1,383.8 | 276.8 |
| Drama | 1,339.9 | 268.0 |
| Comedy | 1,076.1 | 358.7 |

Thriller generates the most total revenue, partly because it has the largest number of films. Comedy has the highest revenue per title, but this result is based on only three films and should be treated cautiously.




# Critically successful films

Using the existing definition—**IMDb rating ≥ 8.0**—the five hit movies are:

| Movie ID | Genre | IMDb rating | Box office ($M) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4004 | Comedy | 9.5 | 437.8 |
| 4006 | Action | 9.1 | 289.3 |
| 4014 | Thriller | 9.0 | 35.9 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 4011 Thriller | 8.6 | 370.3 |
| 4013 Thriller | 8.0 | 277.4 |

Critical success is not synonymous with commercial success in this dataset: the 9.0-rated thriller (Movie 4014) earned just $35.9M, whereas other hit films earned substantially more.

# Recommendations for future productions

1. **Prioritize thrillers for a balanced slate.** They lead average rating, total revenue, and hit count, making them the strongest all-around genre in this sample.
2. **Explore comedy selectively for upside.** Comedy's average revenue per film is the highest, but the small three-film base means additional evidence is needed before scaling investment.
3. **Strengthen the drama development pipeline.** Drama trails on average rating and has no hits; investigate screenplay, talent, release strategy, and audience fit before expanding output.
4. **Separate quality and revenue targets in greenlight decisions.** High ratings do not guarantee box-office performance, so pair expected audience reception with market and distribution assumptions.

# Limitation

These findings are descriptive and based on only 20 movies. Genre sample sizes vary from three to seven films, and the data contains no release timing, production budgets, marketing spend, audience segments, or franchise indicators; therefore, it cannot establish what causes ratings or revenue outcomes.